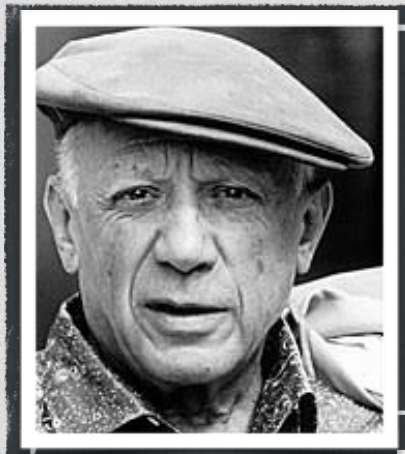
What distinguishes Reproduction from Mechanical Reproduction? How does it affect the following?

- The maker
- The cycle of production
- The value
- The original
- What else?

Your very loving grandfather leaves you this beautiful watch before he passes away. You love it and take it with you to school when you move to school. But once you get to JI you can't find it and are very distressed. You call your parents and they want to make you happy, so they go buy a new one, gently distress it, and send it to you saying they found your grandfather's watch. You are excited, only to learn later that in fact it is only a replica that looks exactly the same. Is it? Are you happy now? Are you upset with your parents or are you grateful?



Scenario 2: Thought Experiment

Roy looked down from the cliffs at the man drawing in the sand. The picture that started to emerge startled him. It was an extraordinary face, not realistically rendered, but seemingly viewed from many angles at once. In fact, it looked much like a Picasso.

As soon as the thought entered his mind, his heart stopped. He lifted his binoculars to his eyes, which he then felt compelled to rub. The an on the beach was Picasso.

Roy's pulse raced. He walked this route every day, and he knew that very soon the tide would sweep in and wash away a genuine Picasso original. Somehow, he had to try and save it. But how?

Trying to hold back the sea was futile. Nor was there any way to take a cast of the sand, even if he had had the time he was actually so short of. Perhaps he could run back home for his camera. But that would at best preserve a record of the work, not the picture itself. And if he did try this, by the time he got back, the image would probably have been erased by the ocean. Perhaps then he should simply enjoy this private view as long as it lasted. As he stood watching, he didn't know whether to smile or cry.

Breakout discussion

- ☐ Think about the reproduction slide and answer the questions

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- ☐ Think about the 2 scenarios.
- ☐ Notice your reaction - how would you have felt in a similar situation?
- ☐ Think about why - what are the implication of your response regarding your belief about art?
- ☐ For the Picasso scenario, would it have made a difference to take a picture? Why or why not? Couldn't the picture or a video of the action preserve the work , after all?
- ☐ What features of art are exposed by your response? Think about, for example - but not limited to - time, space, production
- ☐ What's conceptual differences you see between the two scenarios and your responses to them?